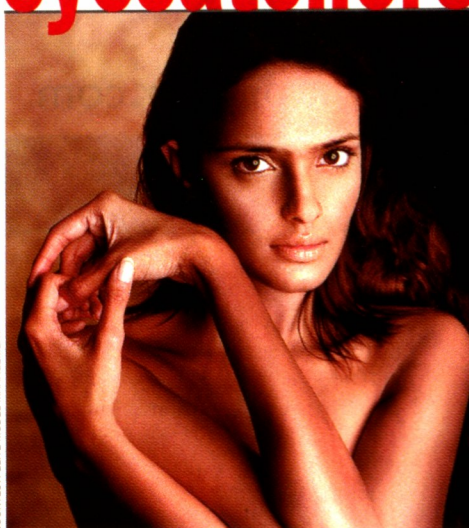


COURTESY: ELITE MODEL MANAGEMENT



RAMPAGE TIME

A lack of fizz was only one of the problems at Lakme India Fashion Week. But two models at the autumn/winter extravaganza are opening the bubbly. International model management firm IMG has chosen **Vipasha Agarwal (L)**, who was last seen in Arjun Rampal-starrer *I See You*, and **Monikangana Dutta** to work on their international projects. "It has been my dream to work with IMG since I started modelling. I think I deserve it," says 23-year-old Dutta, who will walk the ramp at the Australian Fashion Week. At least someone's walking tall.



Director's Cut

Ram Gopal Varma is getting inspired again. After Urmila Matondkar, Antara Mali and Jiah Khan, he has a new muse in the factory. **Amruta Khanvilkar** has been chosen to star in back-to-back Varma films—*Contract* and *Phoonk*. But the 23-year-old doesn't think she's his inspiration. "He wouldn't make me wear saris if I were his muse." Perhaps hot pants, a la Nisha Kothari, would have been more appropriate for Varma's latest object of affection.



FOTOCORP

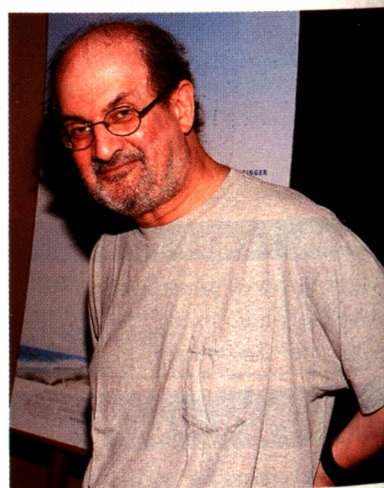
Spooky Star



Aishwarya Rai Bachchan has competition, at least on screen. Actor **Shaana Diya** gets Amitabh Bachchan's attention as his bahu in Vivek Sharma's 'spirited' tale *Bhoothnath*. "I play a strong willed, opinionated character in the film," says the 24-year-old, who's also finished shooting for Lalit Aijaonkar's *Idol*. The actor was born in Switzerland, brought up in London and studied in New York, but after bagging a bit role in *Namaste London*, decided to add to Bandra's population of Bollywood hopefuls.

READY TO ENCHANT

Two-time dad **Salman Rushdie** has a new girlfriend. Could that be why he is preparing for a new role, playing a gynaecologist in Oscar awardee Helen Hunt's directorial debut, *And Then She Found Me*, based on Elinor Lipman's novel of the same name? Rushdie, last seen on the big screen as himself in *Bridget Jones's Diary*, apparently auditioned for the part. As Hunt told *The New York Times*: "It was just strange enough to be a good idea." Hmm. Good enough to get over Padma Lakshmi.



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